

Standard Chartered Plc (HK)
(2888)

2Q26 - strong beat despite high base

2Q26 revenue, PPOP and attributable profits were 3%, 9% and 17% ahead of company-compiled consensus. **STAN is our top pick among HK/CH banks, for the following reasons. First**, revenue growth was stronger than expected, as shown in 2Q results, with Wealth +43% y/y, Banking +18% y/y and Markets flow income +16% y/y offsetting weaker episodic income as flagged. STAN also revised up NII guidance from flat to low single-digit % y/y (cons. +1.7% y/y), partly reflecting the upgraded FY26 total income guidance to the middle of the 5-7% range (vs cons. 6.4%). **Second**, impairment charges were 37% lower than consensus with Middle East-related overlay declining from \$190mn in 1Q26 to \$44mn in 2Q26. The 2Q26 annualized credit cost of 26bps is likely lower than HSBC (JPMe 51bps) and BOCHK (JPMe ~35bps). **Third**, against the backdrop of a tightening on cross-border investment account openings and potential change in individual ODI regulation, client and asset growth remain robust, with 76k new to bank affluent clients, up from 64k in 2Q25. Net new money inflow of \$15bn was lower than \$18bn in 1Q26 and largely flat vs 2Q25 (\$15.6bn) which were respectively the highest and second-highest quarterly flows since disclosure became available. **Fourth**, we expect low-mid single digit cons EPS upgrades post the 2Q print, bringing upside to FY28E cons ROTE (15.5%), up from 11.9% in 2025. The strong ROTE expansion will be the key support for further PB multiple upgrade. STAN is currently trading at 10.0x PE, 1.2x P/B and 1.4x PTNAV, for a ROTE of 14.9% or ROE 12.8% in 27E. We reiterate our OW rating.

- **What we like:** **1)** NII of \$2.87bn was 1% above consensus and flat q/q with volume growth, day count and asset mix benefits offset by lower rates and WRB portfolio actions. AIEAs were flat q/q with underlying loans +2% q/q driven by CIB loans +\$4.9bn (+3% q/q), while WRB loans were +\$1.7bn (+2% q/q), and underlying deposits were +2% q/q driven by both CIB (+\$5.7bn, largely CASA) and WRB deposits (+\$5.2bn q/q) with net new money flows into term deposits resulting in a c2%-pt move in CASA/TD mix. **2)** Other income of \$2.83bn, flat y/y (including DVA of -\$57mn), was 5% above consensus mainly driven by strong growth in Wealth Solutions (+43% y/y) with affluent net new money of \$15bn, as well as Global Banking (+18% y/y) and Markets flow income (+16% y/y) offsetting weaker Episodic income as flagged. Total income was \$5.70bn, 3% above cons. **3)** Costs of \$3.20bn were flattish y/y (and 2% lower than cons), mainly due to a \$74mn provision release related to Korea ELS, as Korea's financial regulator proposed a penalty that was lower than the amount previously advised, for details, please see [link](#). If we exclude Korea ELS and cost-to-achieve expense, OPEX rose 1% y/y. **4)** 3% revenue growth and flat OPEX drove PPOP of \$2.51bn (+8% y/y), 9% above cons. **5)** Credit impairments of \$150m (20bps loan loss rate) were 37% below cons. and included \$44m additional Middle East conflict-related overlays, meaningfully down

Overweight

2888.HK, 2888 HK

Price: HK\$222.80

28 Jul 2026

Price Target: HK\$295.00

PT End Date: 31 Dec 2027

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from \$296mn in 1Q26, driving 2Q PBT of \$2.33bn, 13% above cons. **6)** CET1 of 14.2% was 50bps above cons. with RWAs 2% below cons. and -2% q/q.

- **What we don't like:** **1)** TNAV/sh was \$17.55 vs cons. \$17.80. **2)** buyback of \$1bn was lower vs cons. \$1.1bn, though DPS of 20.4c was 15% above cons. Total return amount (div + SBB) was 1.45bn in 1H26, lower than \$1.6bn in 1H25 and cons of \$1.52bn for 1H26. **3)** STAN's upward-rate NII sensitivity declined, so that every 100bps upward movement on rates will improve NII by \$430mn vs \$500mn in the previous sensitivity.
- **Outlook & Guidance: 2026 NII and Income guidance upgraded:** **1)** Reported income growth to be around the middle of the 5-7% range y/y (prev bottom end of range), implying 2026E revenues of \$22.05bn (vs cons. \$22.17bn), with NII to increase low single-digit % y/y (cons. +1.7% y/y). **2)** Reported costs (ex notables) expected to be c\$13.3bn (vs cons. \$13.34bn). **3)** 2026 statutory RoTE guidance of >12% unchanged (cons. 13.1%). **4)** 2H26 NII to be driven by continued volume growth and asset mix benefit, offset by changes in deposit mix in WRB and continued impact of WRB portfolio actions. **5)** 2H26 RWAs expected to see reversal of the \$4.7bn decline in Q2 as well as the Q4 increase in op. risk RWAs.
- **Performance by key product segments (const-FX) in 2Q:** **1)** Wealth +43% y/y (16% above cons.) with \$15bn net new money or 14% of AUM annualized, with \$9bn in Wealth (15% of Wealth AUM annualized); 76k new-to-bank affluent clients were onboarded. **2)** Global Markets -5% y/y (1% below cons.) with Flow income (+16% y/y) offset by episodic income (-47% y/y against a strong Q2'25). **3)** Global Banking +18% y/y (6% above cons) with Lending & Fin Solutions +15% y/y and Capital Markets & Advisory +46% y/y. **4)** Transaction Services +5% y/y (3% above cons.) with Payments & Liquidity +3% y/y.
- **Middle East exposure.** STAN's Middle East portfolio remained at ~6% of total Group exposure. More than 90% remained in CIB, weighted toward sovereign-linked corporates, sovereigns and financial institutions, with the investment-grade share improving to ~80% from >75% in 1Q26. The UAE accounted for 54% of the Middle East book, followed by Saudi Arabia at 19% and Qatar at 13%. WRB remained below 10% of the regional exposure, with ~85% in the UAE and ~85% comprising secured mortgages and wealth lending. STAN booked a further US\$44mn of Middle East-related impairment in 2Q26, bringing the H1 charge to US\$234mn, versus US\$190mn in 1Q26. The incremental overlays reflected petrochemical-sector risks, potential sovereign downgrades and selected WRB portfolios vulnerable to regional disruption. However, the probability weighting assigned to the Sustained Middle East Conflict" (SMEC) downside scenario was reduced by 10ppt QoQ to 60%, while the base case was recalibrated to reflect a weaker

macro environment. The portfolio has so far remained resilient, although management continues to monitor potential second-order effects.

- **Private credit exposure.** In 2Q26, STAN's private credit (PC) exposures totaled US\$7.0bn, representing ~1% of group exposures, of which US\$5.5bn sat on balance sheet. The book increased ~US\$2.0bn q/q from a low base, with roughly half in indirect lending against diversified portfolios of private credit loans and the remaining half spread across financing to multiple top-tier funds. In terms of risk management, management noted PC exposures are subject to the same stringent underwriting standards as any other credits, and the regular portfolio reviews have not identified any material issues.
- **HK CRE – small marginal changes, overall stable:** In 2Q26, HK CRE exposure increased to US\$1.6bn (vs US\$1.5bn in 1Q) and accounted for 0.5% of total loan book. Management has increased the overlay by \$2mn q/q to \$47mn, to reflect the uncertain outlook that may not yet be fully reflected in the credit grades and modelled ECL.
- **Hong Kong business review.** STAN's HK revenue increased by 5% y/y in 2Q26, decelerating from 10% y/y in 1Q26, while the expense was up 10% y/y, leading to negative jaws and bringing CIR up +2pcts y/y to 45%. As a result, PPOP grew only +1% y/y in 2Q26, vs +16% y/y in 1Q26. Loan impairment charges dropped by -32% y/y, therefore, credit costs on an annualized basis edged down -14bps y/y to 23bps in 2Q, supporting the 4% YoY increase in underlying PBT. Loan growth of +4% q/q (+12% y/y) was ahead of Group loan trend (+2% q/q or +4% y/y), and the deposit growth was strong at +5% q/q (or +6% y/y).
- **Read-across to HK banks:** The read-across is broadly positive for local HK banks, particularly for wealth activity, NII and credit costs. STAN's Hong Kong franchise delivered solid loan (+4% q/q) and deposit (+5% q/q) growth, while annualised credit costs declined 14bps y/y to 23bps. NII remained resilient, supported by balance sheet growth, although further time-deposit migration could create some margin pressure.
- **Read-across to HSBC:** We see these results as a positive read-across for HSBC's Wealth revenues with StanChart Wealth income growth of +43% y/y in 2Q alongside net new money of \$15bn (inc. \$9bn in Wealth). Stan revised up NII guidance for 2026 despite lower rate sensitivity and time deposit migration, market may expect HSBC to upgrade its guidance on banking NII given rise in yield curve.
- **Likely changes to consensus:** We expect low-mid single digit % upgrades to consensus EPS FY26-28E, with stronger revenues (and potential upside to management's FY26 total income guidance) partly offset by higher costs given CIR guidance remains unchanged.
- **Stock price reaction:** We expect the stock to trade up post 2Q26 results.

- **Conference call details:** 08:00 UK/ 15:00 HK on Wednesday, 29 July 2026. You will be able to access the presentation via [webcast link](#) here.

Table 1: StanChart 2Q26 results summary

US\$ m	2Q25	1Q26	2Q26E	2Q26 Cons	2Q26A	A vs Cons.	A vs JPMe	Y/Y	Q/Q
NII	2,702	2,869	2,810	2,839	2,871	1%	2%	6%	0%
Other Income	2,825	3,033	2,689	2,708	2,831	5%	5%	0%	-7%
Revenue	5,527	5,902	5,499	5,547	5,702	3%	4%	3%	-3%
o.w. Transaction Services	1,471	1,512	1,521	1,498	1,542	3%	1%	5%	2%
o.w. Global Banking	548	663	605	617	651	6%	8%	19%	-2%
o.w. Global Markets	1,172	1,190	1,116	1,125	1,116	-1%	0%	-5%	-6%
o.w. Wealth Solutions	742	1,043	899	916	1,064	16%	18%	43%	2%
Operating expenses	-3,201	-3,140	-3,316	-3,252	-3,196	-2%	-4%	0%	2%
Pre-provision operating profit	2,326	2,762	2,183	2,295	2,506	9%	15%	8%	-9%
Loan impairments	-119	-296	-243	-239	-150	-37%	-38%	26%	-49%
Profits pre-Other impairments/Assocs	2,207	2,466	1,941	2,056	2,356	15%	21%	7%	-4%
Other impairments	-4	-2	-6	-9	-19				
Profit from associates	77	-14	5	17	-3				
Clean Pretax profits	2,280	2,450	1,940	2,064	2,334	13%	20%	2%	-5%
Attributable profit	1,708	1,660	1,349	1,455	1,708	17%	27%	0%	3%
DPS	0.12	NA	0.20	0.18	0.20	15%	0%	65%	-
TNAV/s	\$16.80	\$17.20	\$17.88	\$17.80	\$17.55	-1%	-2%	4%	2%
CET1 ratio	14.3%	13.4%	13.6%	13.7%	14.2%				
RWAs	260	266	268	268	262	-2%	-2%	1%	-2%
Loans (amortised cost)	287	294	295	296	299	1%	1%	4%	2%
Customer deposits	517	542	550	554	553	0%	0%	7%	2%
SBB	1,300	NA	1,000	1,119	1000	-11%	0%	-23%	

Source: J.P. Morgan estimates, Company data, Bloomberg Finance L.P.

Table 2: StanChart 2Q26 product revenue

US\$ mn	2Q25	1Q26	2Q26E	2Q26 Cons	2Q26A	A vs Cons.	A vs JPMe	Y/Y	Q/Q
Transaction Services	1,471	1,512	1,521	1,498	1,542	3%	1%	5%	2%
Payments and Liquidity	1,015	1,037	1,053	1,028	1,047	2%	-1%	3%	1%
Securities Services	158	177	167	173	182	5%	9%	15%	3%
Trade & Working Capital	298	298	301	297	313	5%	4%	5%	5%
Banking	548	663	605	617	651	6%	8%	19%	-2%
Lending & Financial Solutions	476	511	514	522	546	5%	6%	15%	7%
Capital Market & Advisory	72	152	91	96	105	9%	15%	46%	-31%
Markets	1,172	1,190	1,116	1,125	1,116	-1%	0%	-5%	-6%
Wealth Solutions	742	1,043	899	916	1,064	16%	18%	43%	2%
Investment Products	544	778	668	686	849	24%	27%	56%	9%
Bancassurance	198	265	232	228	215	-6%	-7%	9%	-19%
CCPL & Other Unsecured Lending	313	296	282	307	281	-8%	0%	-10%	-5%
Deposits & Mortgages	1,004	1,017	1,017	1,018	1,032	1%	1%	3%	1%
Treasury & Other	274	181	58	72	16	-	-	-	-
Total underlying operating income	5,524	5,902	5,499	5,553	5,702				

Source: J.P. Morgan estimates, Company data, Bloomberg Finance L.P..

Table 3: 2Q26 Hong Kong business results

Hong Kong (US\$ mn)	2Q25A	1Q26A	2Q26A	Q/Q	Y/Y
Operating income	1,414	1,514	1,485	-2%	5%
Operating expenses	(599)	(596)	(661)	11%	10%
PPoP	815	918	824	-10%	1%
Loan impairment	(79)	(73)	(54)	-26%	-32%
Other impairment	0	0	(5)	NA	NA
Associates and JV	0	0	0	NA	NA
Underlying PBT	736	845	765	-9%	4%
Total Assets	209,923	222,355	229,358	3%	9%
Customer loans	86,140	92,764	96,296	4%	12%
Customer deposits	187,036	188,111	197,924	5%	6%
Average customer loans	86,170	91,203	94,530	4%	10%
Credit Costs	0.37%	0.32%	0.23%	-9 bps	-14 bps
Cost/ income ratio	42%	39%	45%	515 bps	215 bps
Loan to deposit ratio	46%	49%	49%	-66 bps	260 bps

Source: J.P. Morgan, Company data.

Table 4: StanChart HK CRE exposure summary

In US\$ mn	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	1Q26	2Q26
HK CRE exposure	2,200	2,100	1,800	1,500	1,500	1,640
Stage 1 ratio	64%	65%	53%	62%	NA	NA
Stage 2 ratio	34%	31%	42%	32%	NA	NA
Stage 3 ratio	2%	4%	5%	6%	6%	NA
HK CRE exposure as % of total	0.8%	0.7%	0.6%	0.5%	0.5%	0.5%
Provisions	82	116	134	47	45	47
NPL coverage ratio	186%	138%	149%	52%	50%	NA
LLR / Loans	3.7%	5.5%	7.4%	3.1%	3.0%	2.9%
Unsecured %	17%	19%	11%	14%	12%	NA
Secured %	83%	81%	89%	86%	88%	NA
Average LTV of secured loans	~40%	<50%	<50%	<50%	~50%	~50%

Source: Company data.

Investment Thesis

We view StanChart as undervalued relative to the sector/EM peers at 1.4x PTNAV 27E with significant earnings growth potential supported by structural growth drivers and relatively high capital return. With the Group's 24-26E targets already achieved by FY25 across revenues and distributions, we now forecast ~6% revenue CAGR across '25-28E driven by non-NII in '26E, and broadening out to both NII/non-NII in outer years. We see this led by Wealth (driven by Affluent segment opportunities), Financial Markets (alongside cross-border income) and Banking. We expect NII to be largely flat in FY26 y/y due to lower rates and pass throughs offset by volume growth. We expect a ~1% cost CAGR for '25-28E as we expect growing investments in the future to capitalize on productivity and revenue opportunities, with positive operating leverage annually and the CIR to decline towards mid-50s. Overall, we expect stated ROTE to grow to ~15%, alongside a 35% dividend payout ratio and \$2-2.5bn/y buybacks, offering a total yield of 7-9%/y. Maintain OW.

Valuation

Our Dec-27 PT of HK\$295 is derived from our DDM analysis, with NAV discounted back to Dec-27 from FY28E and a fair P/B of 1.5x. Our key assumptions are a normalized ROE of 12.1% and a cost of capital of 9.3%

Risks to Rating and Price Target

The key downside risks to our rating and price target include:

- **Macroeconomic risks:** Being an EM-focused bank, StanChart is exposed to general macroeconomic risk in EM such as slowdowns, inflationary pressures, depreciation of EM currencies and cross-border and political risks. Potential weakness in China macro and regional sovereign continue to be risks towards revenues and impairments in the near term, as well as geopolitical tensions creating a potential headwind.
- **Provisioning outlook:** We expect provisions to grow to above normalized levels by 2025 given growing pressures in the economic environment. An increase or decrease in provisions as a result of the economic outlook or with regards to specific cases poses a risk to our forecasts.
- **Regulatory uncertainty:** Standard Chartered remains exposed to the changes in the regulatory environment in the UK with capital requirements being set by the PRA in the UK. While StanChart has limited UK exposure, the group is still subject to regulatory changes such as Basel 4 and BoE stress tests.

Other Companies Discussed in This Report (all prices in this report as of market close on 28 July 2026, unless otherwise indicated)

HSBC Holdings plc (0005)(0005.HK/HK\$162.00/OW)

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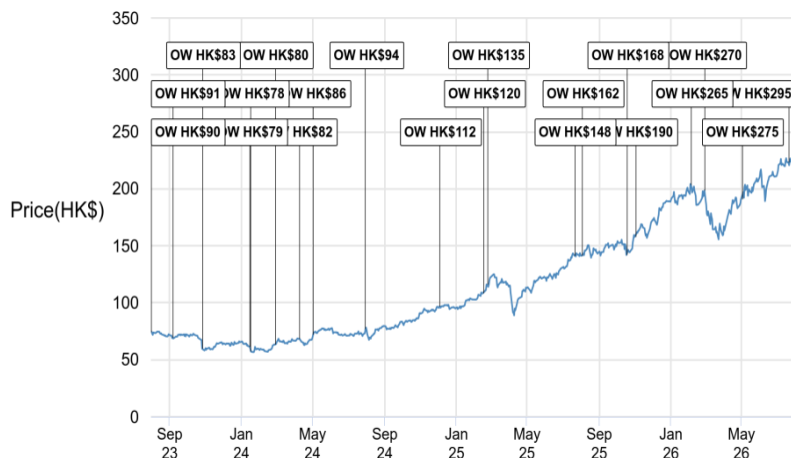
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Standard Chartered Plc (HK) (2888) (2888.HK, 2888 HK) Price Chart



Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage Sep 24, 2002. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

Date	Rating	Price (HK\$)	Price Target (HK\$)
01-Aug-23	OW	74.25	90
07-Sep-23	OW	69.20	91
27-Oct-23	OW	59.75	83
16-Jan-24	OW	61.55	79
18-Jan-24	OW	57.35	78
28-Feb-24	OW	63.35	80
10-Apr-24	OW	68.25	82
03-May-24	OW	71.95	86
31-Jul-24	OW	76.90	94
04-Dec-24	OW	96.80	112
17-Feb-25	OW	108.20	120
24-Feb-25	OW	116.00	135
22-Jul-25	OW	141.30	148
04-Aug-25	OW	141.30	162
19-Oct-25	OW	142.00	168
03-Nov-25	OW	157.80	190
05-Feb-26	OW	203.40	265
01-Mar-26	OW	198.50	270
03-May-26	OW	190.80	275
21-Jul-26	OW	223.00	295

HSBC Holdings plc (0005) (0005.HK, 5 HK) Price Chart



Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage Dec 31, 2000. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

Date	Rating	Price (HK\$)	Price Target (HK\$)
07-Aug-23	OW	63.85	80
16-Oct-23	OW	62.50	81
31-Oct-23	OW	57.20	83
17-Jan-24	OW	59.10	81
22-Feb-24	OW	60.25	74
10-Apr-24	OW	63.90	78
02-May-24	OW	67.00	83
06-Aug-24	OW	62.05	86
19-Nov-24	OW	70.55	90
17-Feb-25	OW	84.50	95
20-Feb-25	OW	88.40	108
20-Mar-25	OW	89.75	115
05-May-25	OW	86.20	108
22-Jul-25	OW	98.45	118
01-Aug-25	OW	96.15	122
30-Oct-25	OW	106.50	132
02-Dec-25	OW	110.50	138
05-Feb-26	OW	139.00	165
18-Mar-26	OW	124.80	180
07-May-26	OW	140.50	182
21-Jul-26	OW	157.80	200

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